PART 10 OF 11 · PUTTING IT TOGETHER

Your cleaning and maintenance schedule

THE SIMPLE VERSION

Some jobs are every day. Some are every week. Some are a few times a year. Stick this page on the fridge and check things off.

How often	Tasks
Daily	Check the bedroom hygrometer. Run the bath fan during and 20 minutes after showers, and wipe shower walls. Empty the dehumidifier if it is not drained. Keep kitchen and bathroom surfaces dry.
Twice weekly	HEPA-vacuum bedroom carpets and rugs. Damp-mop hard floors.
Weekly	Wash all bedding.[1] Damp-dust all surfaces. HEPA-vacuum the rest of the carpet, upholstered furniture, and headboards. Wash throws, removable pillow covers, pet bedding, and washable toys.
Monthly	Look at the HVAC filter and replace it if loaded. Vacuum supply and return grilles. Clean the dehumidifier filter. Wipe window sills and tracks, and look for condensation or staining. Check that the AC drain line is flowing.
Every 3 months	Replace the HVAC filter at minimum, sooner if loaded.[2] Check portable air cleaner pre-filters. Wash curtains. Wipe blinds and ceiling fans thoroughly.
Every 6 to 12 months	HVAC service including coil, drain pan, and drain line; ACAAI suggests every six months.[2] Confirm the fan is on AUTO and the blower-off delay is short. Deep clean carpets. Check under sinks, around toilets, at water heaters, and at window and door frames for leaks.
Twice a year	Do the outside walk-around checklist. Run the water meter test and the window weep test.
Yearly	Do the salt test on your hygrometers.[3] Before hurricane season, check roof, window, slider, and shutter seals. Make an away-from-home plan for the AC.
After any storm or leak	Look for wet spots and stains within 24 hours, and dry anything wet within 24 to 48 hours.[4]

Your next step

Post this page where the family will see it. Put the twice-a-year and yearly tasks on your calendar now.

Sources for this part

1. AAAAI/ACAAI Joint Task Force, Environmental Assessment and Exposure Control of Dust Mites: A Practice Parameter (2013). https://www.aaaai.org/Aaaai/media/Media-Library-PDFs/Allergist%20Resources/Statements%20and%20Practice%20Parameters/Dust mite-2013.pdf

2. ACAAI, Dust Allergies.
https://acaai.org/allergies/allergic-conditions/dust-allergies/

3. Canada Mortgage and Housing Corp., Measuring Humidity in Your Home.
https://publications.gc.ca/collections/collection_2011/schl-cmhc/nh18-24/NH18-24-1-2009-eng.pdf

4. EPA, A Brief Guide to Mold, Moisture and Your Home.
https://www.epa.gov/mold/brief-guide-mold-moisture-and-your-home